

his own prayer, and the cure is completed by a salve which is made under the old man's auspices, and the elaborate preparation of which is most minutely described.

Wäinämöinen now resumes his homeward journey, and has no sooner reached the borders of Kalewala than, by the magical power of his song, he causes a pine-tree to spring out of the earth, and makes a moon and the Great Bear rest upon its branches, which are of gold and reach to the sky. When he arrives at his home, he pays a visit to the smith Ilmarinen, and tells him of the promise he has made in his name. The terrified smith declares that he will not go to the fearful land in the north; but his curiosity is aroused when Wäinämöinen tells him of the golden pine-tree; and he not only hastens with him to inspect it, but climbs to its summit, in order to fetch down the moon and stars. Through one of Wäinämöinen's magic songs, a wind now arises, which wafts Ilmarinen to the northern country, where he finds Louhi awaiting his arrival. She orders her daughter to deck herself in the most costly raiment, in honour of the expected bridegroom, whom she entertains liberally, and then explains that the Sampo is to be made of the feather of a swan, a small barley-corn, the wool of a sheep, and the milk of a cow. Ilmarinen declares his willingness to perform the required task, stating that by his hands the vault of heaven was fashioned. From the fire which he lights in his forge proceed a bow, a boat, a cow, and a plough, all of fair appearance but of mischievous properties, as if to typify the abuses of the implements most necessary to civilised life, and they are all cast back into the fire by Ilmarinen. After three days' hard work on the part of the smith and some assistants whom he engages, the Sampo is made, and turns out to be a miraculous mill, which from its three sides grinds forth corn, salt, and money. Louhi is delighted to possess this wondrous machine, and places it in a copper mountain for security; but her daughter refuses to wed the smith, on the plea that she is unwilling to leave her home, and Ilmarinen is sent back unrewarded to Wäinämöinen.

The thread of the narrative is now interrupted by the appearance of a new hero, the wild youth Ahti, also called Lemminkäinen and Kaukomieli, who falls in love with Kyllikki, a beautiful maiden resident at Suuri; and is not to be deterred from paying his court to her by the fact that she has already refused the sons of the sun, the moon, and a star; nor by the warnings of his mother, who represents that the maiden is of too high origin to justify any hope of success, and will only treat him with scorn. He proceeds to Suuri, where he is at first the laughing-stock of all the girls; but he engages himself as a herdsman, and by his proficiency in dancing soon wins the heart of every maiden save Kyllikki, in visiting whom he wears out a hundred boats and as many oars. All other means proving hopeless, he forcibly carries the proud beauty off in his sledge while she is dancing with some young companions. After a slight altercation, however, she consents to become his wife; and he takes her home to his mother, who is overjoyed to receive them.